



Humana's Election Period Express Guide

Your quick reference to Medicare election periods

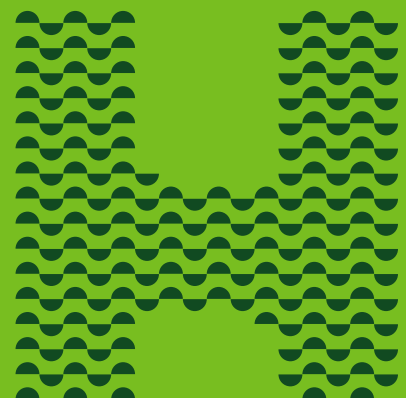
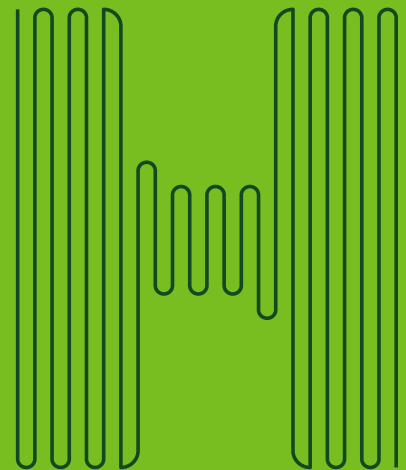
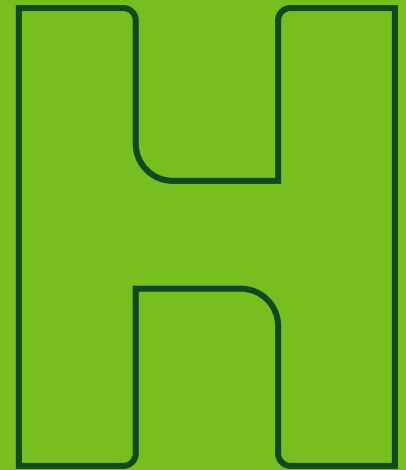
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Introduction

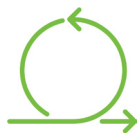
Understanding election periods helps you build your book of business year-round. Consider this short guide an on-the-go reference for quick information and reminders.



Election periods: essentials to know

Understanding election periods is key to helping individuals find the right plans for their changing needs. Adhere to all compliance guidelines from the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) and Humana.

Why election periods matter



Election periods allow consumers to enroll in a Medicare plan for the first time or to switch plans when life changes occur.



Understanding election periods opens up the opportunity for year-round sales and helps keep you compliant.

Can't-miss annual election periods

IEP AND ICEP 3 months before to 3 months after month of Medicare eligibility	These election periods give newly eligible Medicare beneficiaries the opportunity to join a Medicare health and/or prescription drug plan. Initial Enrollment Period (IEP) • Medicare Advantage prescription drugs (MAPD) plans • Prescription drug plans (PDPs) Initial Coverage Enrollment Period (ICEP) • MA-only plans
AEP October 15–December 7	The Annual Election Period (AEP) gives all Medicare beneficiaries an annual chance to join, switch or drop a MA or MAPD plan or PDP.
MA OEP, PART D SEP AND PART B GEP January 1–March 31	• The MA OEP allows MA and MAPD enrollees to change plans if they are dissatisfied with their plans. • If they're switching to Original Medicare, they can also enroll in a PDP.

Get to know Special Election Periods



Special Election Periods (SEPs) give individuals experiencing qualifying life changes the opportunity to shop for plans throughout the year. These include changes in income, residence, health insurance coverage, plan availability and more.

New SEP changes

Quarterly dual-eligible and Low-Income Subsidy/Extra Help SEP has been sunset

CMS has sunset the quarterly SEP for dual-eligible and Low-Income Subsidy (LIS)/Extra Help beneficiaries for 2025.

New monthly dual-eligible and LIS/Extra Help SEP

All dual-eligible and LIS/Extra Help beneficiaries will have a new monthly SEP to disenroll from Medicare Advantage to return to Original Medicare with a standalone prescription drug plan (PDP) using code DEP.

LIS/Extra Help beneficiaries on a standalone PDP can switch to a different standalone PDP once a month using code DEP.

Please note: an individual is not eligible for this SEP if the individual has been identified as an “at-risk beneficiary” or “potential at-risk beneficiary.”

New Integrated SEP for full-benefit eligible dual-eligible individuals

CMS created a new monthly Integrated SEP that can only be used by full-benefit dually eligible individuals (i.e., those who are FBDE, QMB+, SLMB+) to enroll into integrated and aligned Dual Eligible Special Needs Plans (D-SNPs) to align enrollment between their Medicare and Medicaid plans.

The Integrated SEP can be used to enroll into 1 of these 3 plan types:

- 1** A Fully Integrated Dually Eligible Special Needs Plan (FIDE SNP)
- 2** A Highly Integrated Dually Eligible Special Needs Plan (HIDE SNP)
- 3** A D-SNP that is an Applicable Integrated Plan (AIP)

Humana HIDE, FIDE and AIP D-SNPs are only available in certain states. Learn more [here](#).

Election periods: essentials to know (cont.)

Compliance reminders

- Certain SEPs are prohibited from agent use and can only be used by CMS.
- Certain SEPs require additional documentation to be submitted with the enrollment form and thus can only be submitted via paper application.
- While CMS identifies a hierarchy to election periods, when a beneficiary has more than one election period available, CMS expects agents to use the one that is most beneficial to them.

This is the hierarchy:

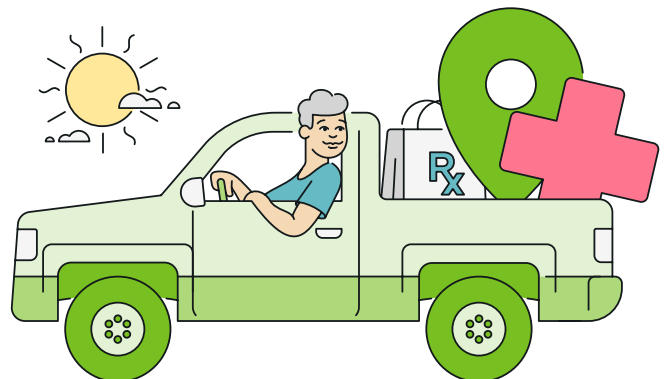
- | | | |
|------------|-------|---|
| ① IEP/ICEP | ③ SEP | ⑤ Open Enrollment Institutional (when moving into, residing in or moving out of an institution for MA/MAPD) |
| ② MA OEP | ④ AEP | |

- CMS regulations specify using the SEP that results in an effective date of the first of the month after the enrollment request is received by the plan (or soonest one possible).

Help consumers meet their changing needs

Understanding election periods helps you better serve consumers while opening up more sales opportunities.

Always conduct a thorough [Now, Enjoy, Explore, Decision, Summary \(NEEDS\) analysis](#) and check whether consumers are eligible for a valid election period considering a new plan.



Prohibited SEPs for agents

Certain SEPs may only be used by CMS, at CMS's discretion, if the circumstances meet their requirements and are prohibited for agent use.



Only 1-800-Medicare representatives may use the following SEPs. Licensed Medicare sales agents may not use these SEPs.

- ✗ Enroll/disenroll in connection with CMS Sanction
- ✗ Contract violations
- ✗ Individuals not adequately informed of loss of creditable coverage
- ✗ Federal employee error causing enrollment or disenrollment in Part D
- ✗ Significant change in provider network
- ✗ Other exceptional circumstances



An overview of election periods

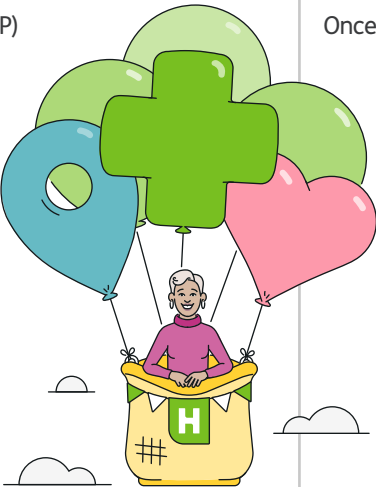
Here's your quick-reference chart on election periods.

Election period	Who it's for	What it is
Initial Enrollment Period (IEP) or Initial Coverage Enrollment Period (ICEP)	Newly eligible Medicare beneficiaries Beneficiaries who are eligible for Medicare before their 65th birthday get a second IEP/ICEP upon turning 65	Their first opportunity to join a Medicare health plan
Medicare Supplement Open Enrollment Period (OEP)	For Medicare beneficiaries who are enrolling in Part B and are 65 or older	A one-time enrollment period to gain Medicare Supplement coverage without medical underwriting
Annual Election Period or Annual Enrollment Period (AEP)	All Medicare beneficiaries	Their annual chance to change MA/MAPD or PDP plans
Medicare Advantage Open Enrollment Period (MA OEP)	MA/MAPD enrollees	Their annual chance to change MA/MAPD plans if dissatisfied Reminder: The MA OEP should not be marketed by agents as the process must be initiated by the beneficiary, not the agent
Open Enrollment Period—New (OEP-NEW)	Beneficiaries who enrolled into an MA/MAPD plan themselves online and didn't understand what they enrolled into, or virtually with an agent and found the plan is not the best fit for their needs	A one-time chance to change MA/MAPD plans if dissatisfied
Delayed Part B (or Delayed Part A)	If a person has Medicare Part A and opted out of Medicare Part B when first eligible and then later enrolled in Part B (or the reverse)	Chance to enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan
Part D creditable coverage SEP (SEP-CDC)	Individuals who disenroll from Part D to enroll in or maintain other creditable coverage	Their chance to enroll in an MA-only plan because they have creditable drug coverage from another source
SEPs	Medicare beneficiaries who have certain events occur in their lives	Their chance to make a change to their plan when special circumstances occur

What they can do	When it's available
IEP: Enroll in a MAPD or a standalone PDP ICEP: Enroll MA-only	7 months • 3 months before eligibility month • Month of eligibility • 3 months after eligibility month • Coverage begins on the first of the month of eligibility or during or after the month of eligibility, of the month following enrollment
Enroll in any Medicare Supplement policy in a beneficiary's state Please note: After this period, beneficiaries may not be able to buy a Medicare Supplement policy, may have fewer Medicare Supplement policy options or the options they do have could cost more	It's a one-time enrollment period that begins the first month a beneficiary has Medicare Part B and is 65 or older and ends 6 months later • This enrollment period does not repeat
Join, switch or drop an MA or MAPD or PDP	October 15–December 7 • Coverage begins on the first of the following year
Switch or drop MA/MAPD plans Active MA/MAPD member can make a one-time change to a different MA/MAPD or return to Original Medicare with or without a PDP	January 1–March 31 • OEP coverage begins the month following application submission
Switch to a different MA/MAPD plan Beneficiaries who wait to use their IEP/ICEP until the month of their Medicare effective date or later during that initial 7-month window will reduce or even forfeit their OEP. NOT eligible for 2nd use with 2nd IEP/ICEP upon turning 65 for those on Medicare due to disability To disenroll from an MA/MAPD plan and enroll in a PDP-only, use SEP-OEP	OEP is available to new Medicare Advantage enrollees following IEP/ICEP with their Medicare entitlement
Use their ICEP to enroll in MA or MAPD	The 3 months prior to the effective date for Part B, the month of until the end of the second month—a 5 month window
Beneficiaries may disenroll from a PDP or MAPD plan to enroll in or maintain other creditable coverage (such as TriCare or VA coverage) and enroll in an MA-only plan	The effective date of enrollment is the first day of the month following the month the enrollment request is received by the organization
Depends on the specific SEP	Varies by SEP. See DMS-024 in Mentor or Vantage for further information

An overview of election periods (cont.)

Election period	Who it's for	What it is
New monthly dual-eligible and LIS/Extra Help SEP (DEP)	All dual-eligible and LIS/Extra Help beneficiaries Please note: An individual is not eligible for this SEP if the individual has been identified as an “at-risk beneficiary” or “potential at-risk beneficiary”	Monthly SEP for individuals who have Medicare and receive any type of Federal or State assistance from Medicaid or Low Income Subsidy (LIS)/Extra Help to newly enroll into or change to a different PDP
New monthly Integrated SEP (INT)	Restricted to full-benefit dual-eligible beneficiaries (i.e., those who are FBDE, QMB+ or SLMB+)	A monthly SEP for full-benefit dual-eligible beneficiaries to enroll into integrated and aligned D-SNPs to align enrollment between their Medicare and Medicaid plans The Integrated SEP can only be used to enroll into 1 of these 3 plan types: 1. A Fully Integrated Dually Eligible Special Needs Plan (FIDE SNP) 2. A Fully Integrated Dually Eligible Special Needs Plan (FIDE SNP) 3. A D-SNP that is an Applicable Integrated Plan (AIP) • Humana HIDE, FIDE and AIP D-SNPs are only available in certain states • Learn more here
SEP for those who gain, lose or have a change in their Medicaid status (MCD)	Beneficiaries who have a gain, loss or a change in their Medicaid status and they: 1. Become eligible for any type of assistance from the Title XIX program (including “partial duals” who receive cost sharing assistance under Medicaid or 2. Lose eligibility for any type of assistance or 3. Have a change in the level of assistance they receive (e.g., stop receiving Medicaid benefits, but still qualify for LIS, those who have a change in cost sharing)	An SEP for individuals who have a gain, loss or change in their Medicaid status to enroll into a MA/MAPD or PDP plan
SEP for those who gain, lose or have a change in their Low-Income Subsidy (LIS)/Extra Help status (NLS)	Beneficiaries who either: 1. Become eligible for LIS/Extra Help but do not receive Medicaid benefits. Beneficiaries whose income is up to 150% of the federal poverty line will be eligible for LIS 2. Lose eligibility for any type of assistance	An SEP for individuals who have a gain, loss or change in their LIS/Extra Help status to enroll into MAPD or PDP plan
Chronic Condition SEP (CSN)	1. Eligible for a Chronic Condition Special Needs Plan (C-SNP) because they have a severe or disabling qualifying condition 2. Not qualified for the C-SNP and need to enroll into a different plan 3. Eligible for a different C-SNP because they have a chronic condition that is not the focus of their current C-SNP	1. Their chance to enroll in a C-SNP with a qualifying condition 2. An SEP that begins when the plan notifies the individual they are not eligible for a C-SNP and ends on the last day of the second month following the notification 3. The opportunity for current C-SNP enrollees to switch from one C-SNP to another that focuses on a different condition

What they can do	When it's available
- For dual-eligible or LIS/Extra Help beneficiaries in an MA or MAPD, they can return to Original Medicare and enroll in a standalone PDP - For dual-eligible or LIS/Extra Help beneficiaries in a standalone PDP, they can switch to another standalone PDP - This SEP cannot be used to switch to a different MA or MAPD plan	Once per month beginning January 1, 2025
Enroll into an integrated D-SNP (HIDE, FIDE or AIP) once per month year-round 	Once per month beginning January 1, 2025
Enroll into an available MA/MAPD or PDP that they qualify for This is a one-time opportunity to make an election with each change in status. The plan effective date is the first day of the month following receipt of the enrollment request	Beneficiaries can use this SEP within 3 months of their gain, loss or change in Medicaid status or upon notification of such a change, whichever is later
Make an election within 3 months of the gain, loss or change in their LIS/Extra Help status, or the notification of such a change, whichever is later The effective date for enrollments under this SEP is the first day of the month following receipt of the enrollment request	Beneficiaries can use this SEP within 3 months of their gain, loss or change in LIS/Extra Help status or upon notification of such a change, whichever is later
- Enroll in a C-SNP - Enroll in a different MA/MAPD/PDP - Enroll in a different C-SNP that focuses on a different chronic condition	- One-time SEP that lasts as long as the individual has a chronic condition and ends when they enroll in a C-SNP - Begins when the plan notifies the individual of their lack of eligibility and ends when the individual makes an enrollment into a different MA/MAPD plan or on the last day of the second month following the notification - Begins when the individual qualifies for a C-SNP focused on a different condition and ends when the individual enrolls in a new C-SNP

Quick view of election periods

Get a snapshot of Medicare Advantage election periods throughout the year. Depending on the beneficiary’s situation, they may have other election periods available to them.

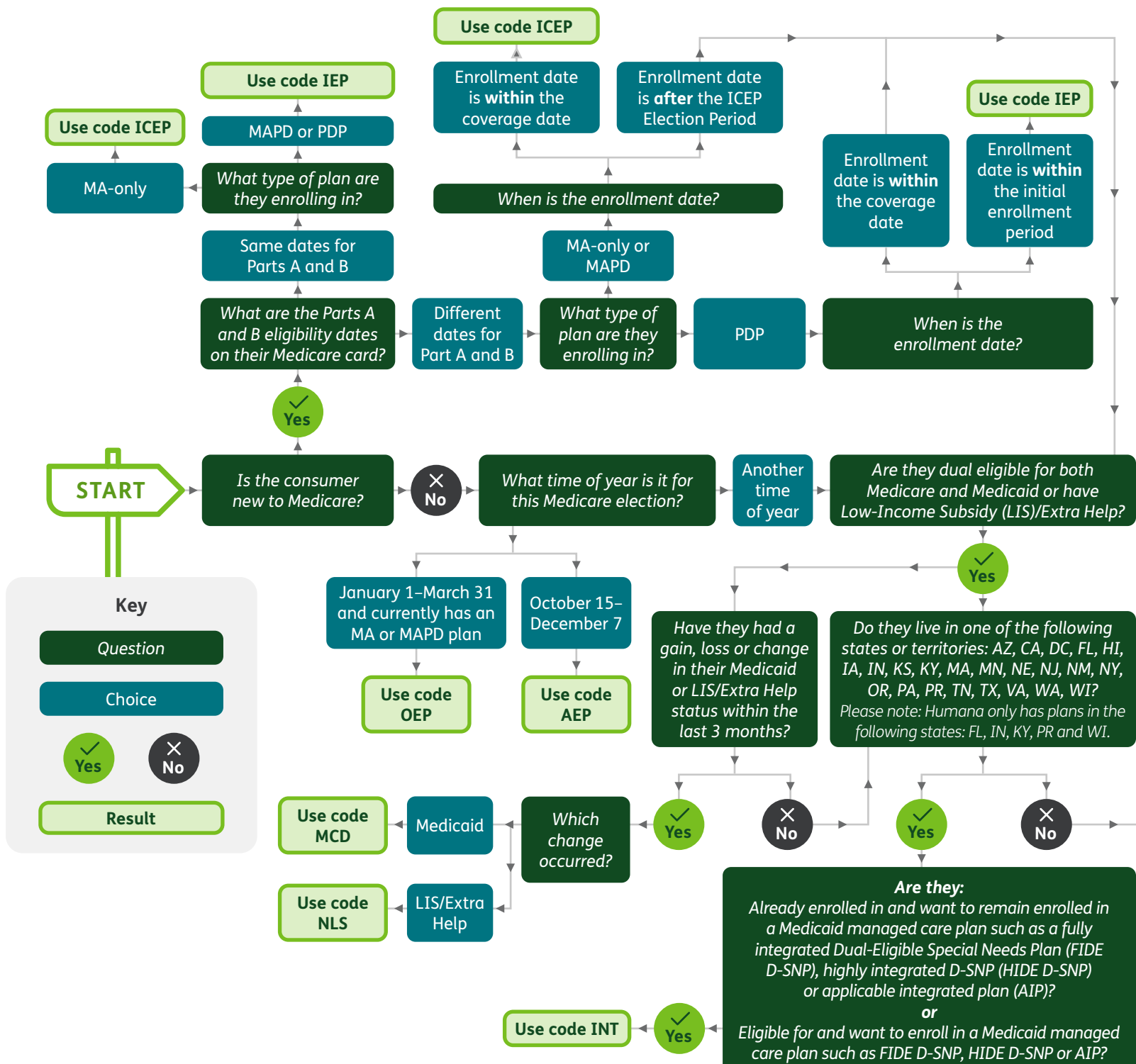
	Q1			Q2	
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May
MA OEP, Part B GEP, Part D SEP					
	January 1–March 31				
Monthly SEP for dual eligible and LIS beneficiaries					
Monthly Integrated SEP for full-benefit dually eligible individuals					
AEP, Part D OEP					
IEP, ICEP or eligible SEP					

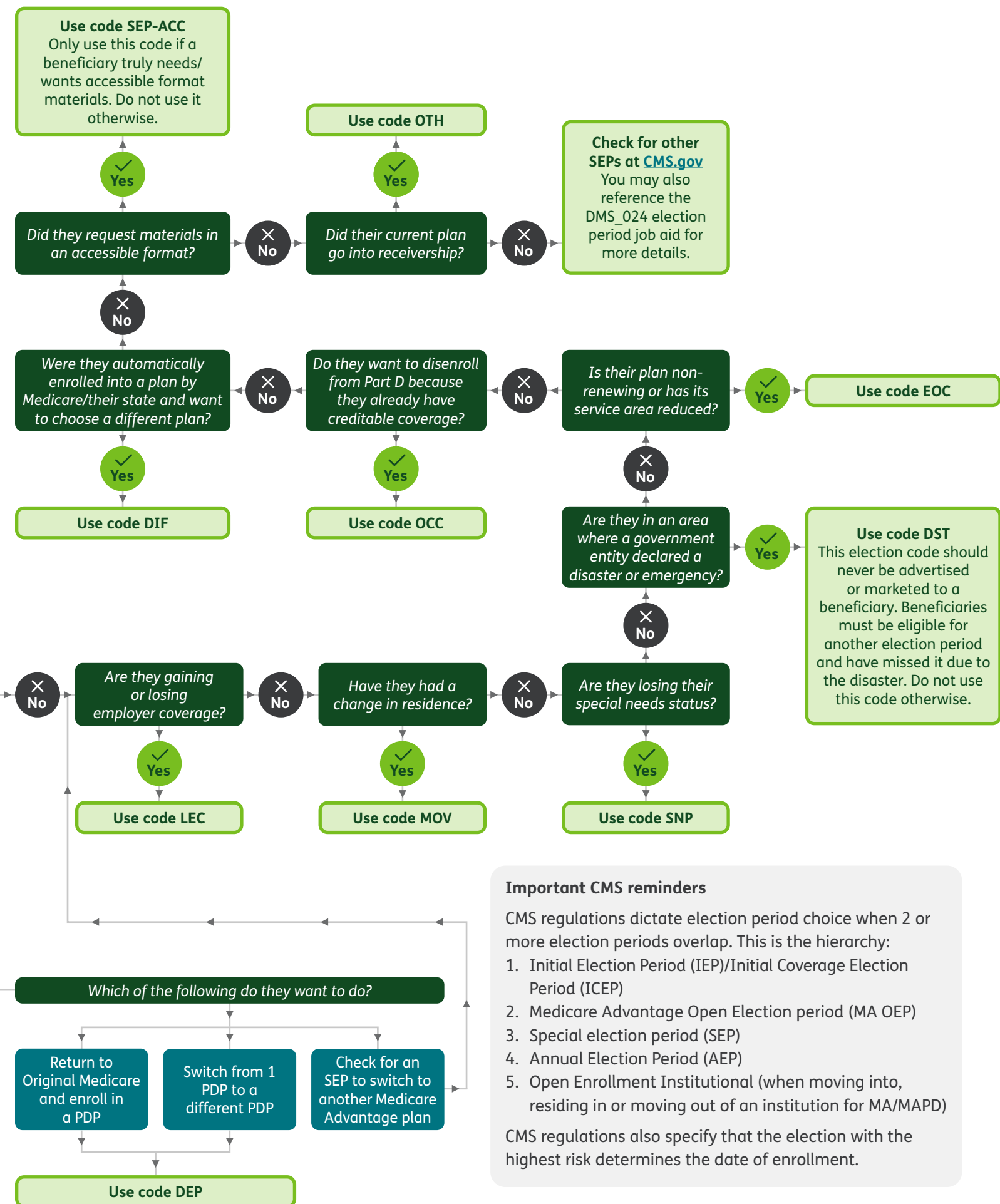


October 15–December 7

Humana's decision tree for election periods

Use this decision tree to help you determine which election period to use. Please note: Agents must confirm beneficiaries meet the requirements of the election code chosen. Other election codes besides the ones listed in this tool may be available.



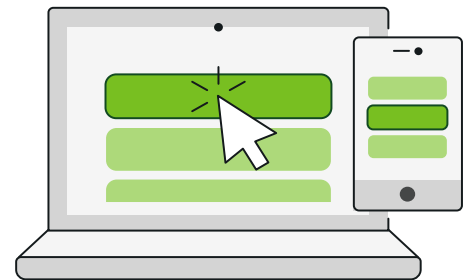


Glossary of election codes

Use this glossary as a quick-reference tool for election codes. Be sure to confirm beneficiaries meet the requirements of the election period you select.

Important reminders

- 1 If consumers want to shop for a new plan using an SEP, double-check DMS-024 on Vantage or Mentor for the specific requirements for the relevant SEP to be sure the individual is eligible.
- 2 Always be sure to use the correct election period code and to follow all regulations concerning communications and marketing for each SEP.
- 3 If you're not sure which election period to use, consult our new, interactive election period tool. Coming soon.



Major annual election periods

Election code	Election period
IEP	Initial Election period for Part D coverage (MAPD or PDP)
ICEP	Initial Coverage Election Period for Medicare coverage (MA/MAPD)
AEP	Annual Election Period or Annual Enrollment Period for Medicare coverage from October 15–December 7 each year. This time period is also shared by the Part D Open Enrollment Period.
OEP	MA Open Enrollment Period from January 1–March 31. This time period is also shared by the Part B General Enrollment Period and Part D Special Enrollment Period.

Common SEPs

Election code	Election period
LEC	SEP for Employer/Union Group Health Plan (EGHP)
DEP	Monthly SEP for all dually eligible individuals and LIS/Extra Help-only individuals to disenroll from a Medicare Advantage plan with prescription coverage (Medicare Advantage Prescription Drug plan or MAPD plan), return to Original Medicare and enroll in a standalone PDP
DEP	Monthly SEP for all dually eligible individuals and LIS-only individuals to switch to a different standalone PDP enrollment
INT	Monthly integrated SEP that can only be used for full-benefit dually eligible individuals to enroll into integrated and aligned D-SNPs to align enrollment between their Medicare and Medicaid plans This SEP can be used to enroll into 1 of these 3 D-SNP types: 1. A Fully Integrated Dually Eligible Special Needs Plan (FIDE SNP) 2. A Highly Integrated Dually Eligible Special Needs Plan (HIDE SNP) 3. A D-SNP that is an Applicable Integrated Plan (AIP)
MCD	Medicare beneficiaries who gain, lose or experience a change in their Medicaid status may qualify for this SEP and have 1 opportunity to make an election within 3 months of the change or notification. Their coverage becomes effective the first day of the month after enrollment submission.
MOV	SEP for changes in residence
SNP	SEP for individuals who lose special needs status
DST	SEP for government-entity-declared disaster or other emergency
EOC	SEP for contract non-renewal or service area reduction
CSN	Chronic Condition SEP to: 1. Enroll in a C-SNP when beneficiary is first eligible 2. Switch to another MA/MAPD plan if beneficiary no longer qualifies for a C-SNP 3. Switch to another C-SNP if beneficiary qualifies for a different chronic condition
NLS	SEP for individuals who gain, lose or have a change in their LIS/Extra Help status to enroll in an MAPD or PDP plan. Eligible beneficiaries are those who either: 1. Become eligible for LIS/Extra Help but do not receive Medicaid benefits. Beneficiaries whose income is up to 150% of the federal poverty line will be eligible for LIS. 2. Lose eligibility for any type of assistance. The SEP allows the individual a single opportunity to make an election within 3 months of the gain, loss or change in their LIS/Extra Help status, or the notification of such a change, whichever is later. The effective date for enrollments under this SEP is the first day of the month following receipt of the enrollment request.

Uncommon SEPs

Election code	Election period
OCC	SEP for individuals who disenroll from Part D to enroll in other creditable coverage
DIF	SEP for CMS and state-initiated enrollments
ACC	SEP for providing individuals who requested materials in accessible formats equal time to make enrollment decisions (only use this code if a beneficiary truly needs/wants accessible format materials—do not use it otherwise)
OTH	SEP for individuals enrolled in a plan placed in receivership

Frequently asked questions

Q: Is there an election period for beneficiaries moving into, residing in or moving out of an institution?

A: There is an open and unlimited use enrollment period for Medicare beneficiaries residing in an institution lasting for up to 2 months after leaving the facility which is OEP-I for MA/MAPD and SEP-LTC for PDP.

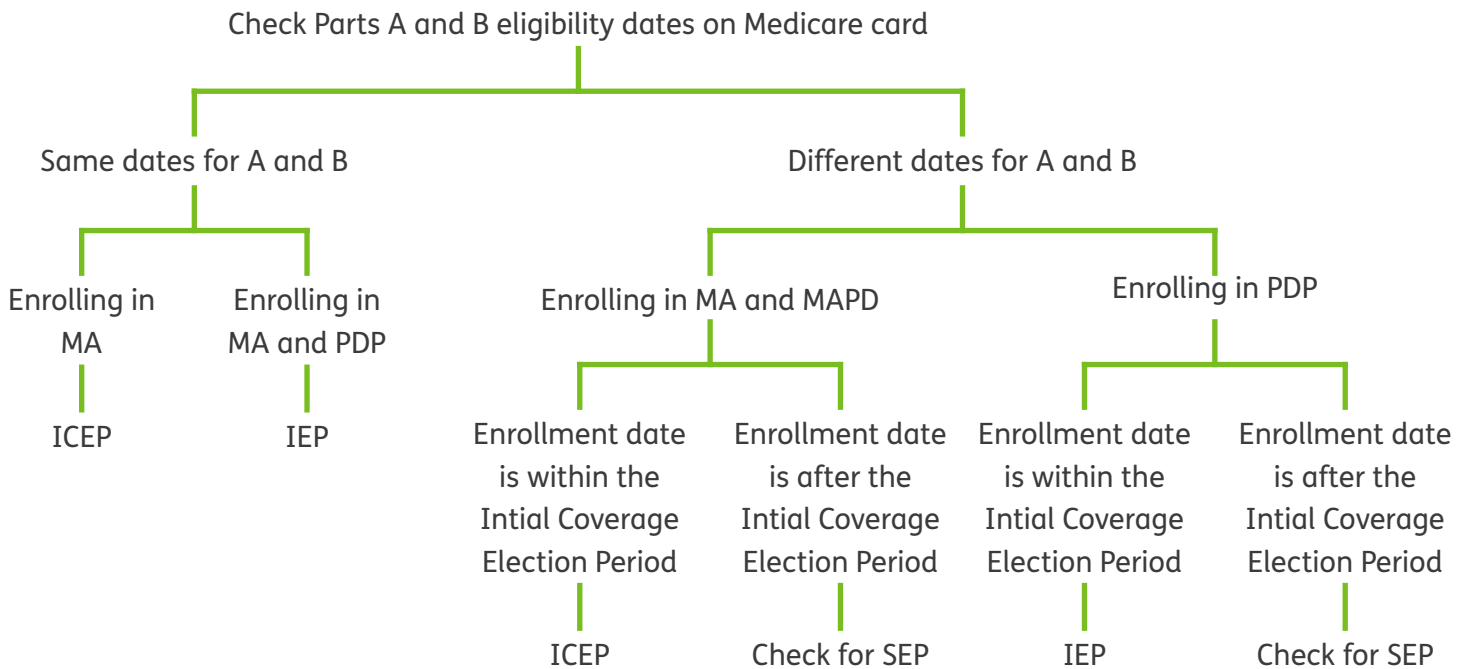
Q: How do I handle beneficiaries who had Medicare due to disability and are turning 65?

A: Beneficiaries with Medicare due to disability (before age 65) will have a second IEP/ICEP election (7-month period) when they turn 65 to change/enroll in a MA/MAPD/PDP. A beneficiary is not required to have used the first ICEP/IEP in order to use the second election at age 65.



Initial election period quick reference

You can refer to this chart as a quick reference to help you narrow down initial election period eligibility.



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